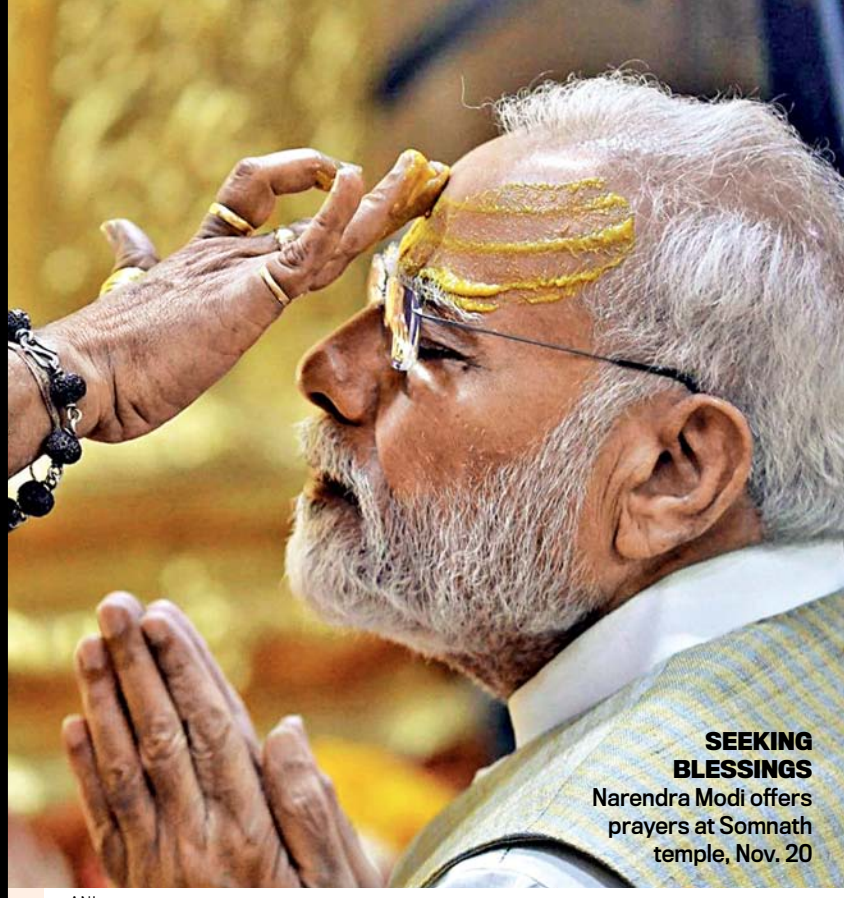


SEEKING BLESSINGS
Narendra Modi offers prayers at Somnath temple, Nov. 20

ANI

GUJARAT IS THE REASON FOR MODI'S PHENOMENAL AND HISTORIC RISE TO THE TOP. HE HAS TO WIN IT, AND WIN IT BIG

tion for the BJP; he remains the party's trump card. With the BJP in power in Gujarat for a quarter of a century, the party's biggest threat is anti-incumbency, and it is working doubly hard to protect its turf. But, as political analyst Ghanshyam Shah points out, "Getting voter connect with the Gujarati *asmita* and *vikaas* (development) planks is receiving lukewarm response. The only factor that seems to still hold strong is Modi's charisma, which will enable the BJP to win the election again." It will truly be remarkable, because even in 2017 when the Congress mounted a formidable challenge, the party managed to win, primarily because of Modi, even though by a reduced majority.

For years, the Congress has remained the BJP's primary challenger in the state. Even before, elections here had always been a bipolar contest. This time, however, the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) headed by Arvind Kejriwal has been gaining traction. This means that for the first time, the polls are expected to be a triangular contest on most seats. Opinion polls conducted by Lokniti-CSDS in October and CVoter this month indicate that AAP is substantially cutting into the Congress vote share rather than that of the BJP. In 2017, the BJP had cornered 49.1 per cent of the vote share and the

THE BLITZKRIEG

20
Days PM Narendra Modi has spent in Gujarat since March

8
Days Modi is devoting to campaigning, addressing 3-4 rallies daily

16
Days Amit Shah spent in Gujarat in Sept.-Oct. prepping for elections

50
Rallies addressed by Shah after the poll date announcement

40
The number of star campaigners the BJP has deployed across Gujarat



AMIT THAKER
Former president, BJYM

A former student and youth wing leader, he is anchoring the campaign in 14 tribal-dominated districts



ATUL LIMAYE
RSS kshetra pracharak (paschim)

With constituency-wise RSS network, anchors the affiliates' outreach among tribals and Dalits



SIDDHARTH PATEL
Convenor, social media, Gujarat BJP

Driving the online campaign across 15 platforms with an army of 20,000 workers and 60,000 volunteers

WHO ARE THE STAR CAMPAIGNERS?

- Besides Shah, Rupala and Mandaviya, their cabinet collegaues Rajnath Singh and Nitin Gadkari are also drumming up support for the party's candidates
- BJP president J.P. Nadda is spending around 10 days in the state, addressing 40-odd rallies
- Chief Ministers Yogi Adityanath (UP), M.L. Khattar (Haryana), Himanta Biswa Sarma (Assam), Shivraj Singh Chouhan (MP), Jairam Thakur (HP), Pramod Sawant (Goa) and Maharashtra deputy CM Devendra Fadnavis are also pitching in

Text by **ANILESH S. MAHAJAN**